To strengthen the network of stroke care centers and mobilize nursing homes, nurses, and support staff, Marengo Asia Hospitals launched the Strokologist Program to train the community of physicians, critical care specialists, and ICU and ER doctors and empower them with the skills for timely diagnosis and treatment as soon as a stroke patient is brought under their care. Marengo Asia Hospitals, through this program, has already trained over 1000 consultants."

Dr. K Madan Gopal, Advisor to NHSRC, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, GOI stated "Addressing stroke care in India requires a multi-faceted approach that integrates prevention, timely diagnosis, and robust infrastructure. While programs like hypertension and diabetes screening under the National Program for Non-Communicable Diseases are vital, the real challenge lies in building capacity, from increasing the number of neurologists to leveraging digital health solutions like telemedicine. Collective efforts from public and private sectors are essential to bridge these gaps and create a sustainable impact on stroke prevention and management." Mr. Arjun Chaudhary participated on behalf of Shri Prataprao Jadhav, Hon'ble Minister of State for Health & Family Welfare and AYUSH.

The agenda progressed with a panel discussion on Policy Frameworks for Stroke Prevention and Acute Care, moderated by Dr. Arvind Sharma, Secretary of the Indian Stroke Association. Panelists, including Dr. Nirmal Surya and Dr. Roopa Shivashankar, discussed strategies for standardizing care, ensuring equitable treatment access, and leveraging stroke data registries for improved outcomes."
Followed by a fireside chat, focusing on Innovation in Stroke Prevention, moderated by Dr. Deepak Yadav. Experts like Dr. P. Ganeshkumar from ICMR and Dr. P. N. Renjen from Indraprastha Apollo Hospitals explored the role of digital health tools in addressing key stroke risk factors such as hypertension and diabetes.

The second panel, which addressed Quality- Driven Care Through Accreditation and Standardization, featured, Dr. Kunal Bahrani (Marengo Asia Hospitals), Dr. Arvind Sharma (ISA), Dr. Bindu Menon (Apollo, Nellore), Dr. Vikram Hudded (Narayana Health and Past President ISA), and Dr. P. Vijaya (President-Elect ISA) she joined the panel virtually with Mr. Neeraj Lal moderating the session. The discussion emphasized evidence-based practices that enhance patient-centered stroke care.

As **Dr. Kunal Bahrani, Clinical Director, Neurology, Marengo Asia Hospitals, Faridabad,** shared, "Over the years, we've witnessed significant advancements in stroke management, including the development of dedicated stroke units. However, it's now crucial to focus on quality- driven care. Every procedure we perform raises whether we are doing it correctly, which is why quality check parameters are essential. Achieving accreditation not only elevates a center but also helps it stand out, allowing other hospitals to learn from its practices. These standards set the protocols and parameters that guide patient care at the hospital, ensuring excellence in stroke treatment."

Dr. Arvind Sharma emphasized "To approach stroke care in a systematic and protocol- driven way makes a tremendous difference in how we treat patients. I believe that hospitals that undergo accreditation and implement quality-driven care see a significant improvement in patient outcomes. We've observed an increase in the number of patients recovering in better shape, not only in the acute treatment phase but also in rehabilitation. This has sparked greater interest in improving care from the management side, ultimately enhancing the entire stroke care process."

The event also delved into Acute Stroke Management during the critical golden hour, with a panel featuring leaders like Dr. Mukesh Sharma (Marengo Asia Hospitals, Ahmedabad) Dr. Padma Srivastava (Chairperson Neurology, PARAS Hospital) as she chaired the session, and Dr. Kaushik Sundar. They explored how partnerships with ambulance services and technology providers streamline rapid-response systems to improve patient outcomes.



Marengo Asia Hospitals, as the presenting sponsor of the 2nd Edition of the National Stroke Conclave and Awards, showcased its commitment to advancing stroke care in India. Their leadership in implementing evidence- based practices and high-quality care is setting new standards in the field.
Dr. Mukesh Sharma, Clinical Director, Neurointervention and Stroke, Marengo Asia Hospitals, Ahmedabad, also added "Acute stroke management hinges on the critical first moments; leveraging technology and strategic partnerships within the golden hour can dramatically improve outcomes, ensuring that every second counts in saving lives and preserving function.". Marengo Asia Hospitals continues to lead in stroke care innovation and excellence.

The day concluded with discussions on Technological Innovations in Stroke Care which featured many eminent speakers including **Dr. Vikram Huded, Director & Clinical Lead, of the Interventional Neurology Programme, Narayana Health Group. He stated** "In neurology, stroke is the area where AI will play a significant role. The guidelines in neurology are changing rapidly, and what we knew about stroke just last week has already been updated by new trials. This is why we need to develop specific, AI-based guidelines for stroke care. These guidelines could be implemented across India, taking the form of AI-driven protocols to ensure consistency and improved outcomes in stroke management."

The last panel focused on Global Best Practices in Stroke Rehabilitation, highlighting advancements such as artificial intelligence, telemedicine, and advanced imaging techniques. Esteemed speakers, including, Dr. Amit Batra, and Prof. Suvarna Shyam Ganvir, presented cutting-edge strategies for better diagnosis, treatment, and recovery.

The Stroke Innovation & Excellence Awards concluded the event on a high note, celebrating pioneers and institutions driving groundbreaking advancements in stroke care. Key resolutions and takeaways from the conclave included the need for widespread implementation of accredited stroke units, adopting AI-driven protocols for consistent care, and enhanced partnerships to ensure rapid response during the critical golden hour.

The 2nd Edition of the National Stroke Conclave and Awards emerged as a pivotal platform for fostering collaboration, innovation, and actionable strategies to combat India's stroke epidemic, paving the way for timely, effective, and equitable care for all stroke patients.